commemorated here on the other side of the planet. I was happy to see an Indian glorified by NASA as a hero of warfare rocketry.

My impression of the American people can be summarized by a quotation from Benjamin Franklin, “Those things that hurt instruct!” I realised that people in this part of the world meet their problems head on. They attempt to get out of them rather than suffer them.

My mother had once narrated an incident from the Holy Book— after God created man, he asked the angels to prostrate themselves before Adam. Everybody prostrated themselves except Iblis, or Satan, who refused. “Why did you not prostrate yourself?” Al ah asked. “You created me of fire and him of clay. Does not that make me nobler than Adam?” Satan contended. God said, “Be gone from paradise! This is no place for your contemptuous pride.” Satan obeyed, but not before cursing Adam with the same fate. Soon Adam fol owed suit by becoming a transgressor after eating the forbidden fruit. Al ah said, “Go hence and may your descendants live a life of doubt and mistrust.”

What makes life in Indian organizations difficult is the widespread prevalence of this very contemptuous pride. It